

MAP-COMBAT-S01-03 - Creature Mercy / Defensive Escalation Battlefield

Player text

The road tightens around the wreck. The creature plants herself between you and the young, wings half-open, claws in the mud. The cart, the ditch, and the low branches turn the bend into a narrow standoff.

Public objective

The road tightens around the wreck. The creature plants herself between you and the young, wings half-open, claws in the mud. The cart, the ditch, and the low branches turn the bend into a narrow standoff.

GM goal

Use this only if the encounter turns physical. Make the combat board a recoverable failure state where restraint can still win.

GM notes

- The creature defends and flees. She does not fight to the death unless the table hard-commits to killing a fleeing mother.
- Winning does not mean killing her. Winning means road cleared and no one made the world worse.

GM script

Say: "This is not a monster hunt. This is a defensive standoff. Every turn, you can escalate by threatening her or the young, or de-escalate by creating space, lowering weapons, opening the pups' escape route, or calming her."

State controls

- strixwolfDisposition Creature disposition select calm wary defensive fleeing Move one step toward calm for restraint, one step toward defensive for threats.

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